

# PARISHRAM 2027

## A ROADSIDE STAND

Lecture -12 Class 12

By Anurag Tyagi Sir

# Topics to be Covered

1 Warm-up Game

2 A Roadside Stand

3 Exercise and Quiz



# A ROADSIDE STAND

Robert Frost

Class 12<sup>th</sup> English

Small  
People  
Big  
Dreams...



FRESH  
FROM  
OUR FARM  
A SMALL  
HOPE  
A BRIGHTER  
TOMORROW

GOOD  
FOOD  
KINDER  
PEOPLE  
BRIGHTER  
DAYS

BERRIES  
SQUASH  
FARM PRODUCE  
LOCAL ♥ HONEST

SOME  
PEOPLE  
JUST  
PASS...  
♥ BUT  
WE STILL  
STAND  
♥

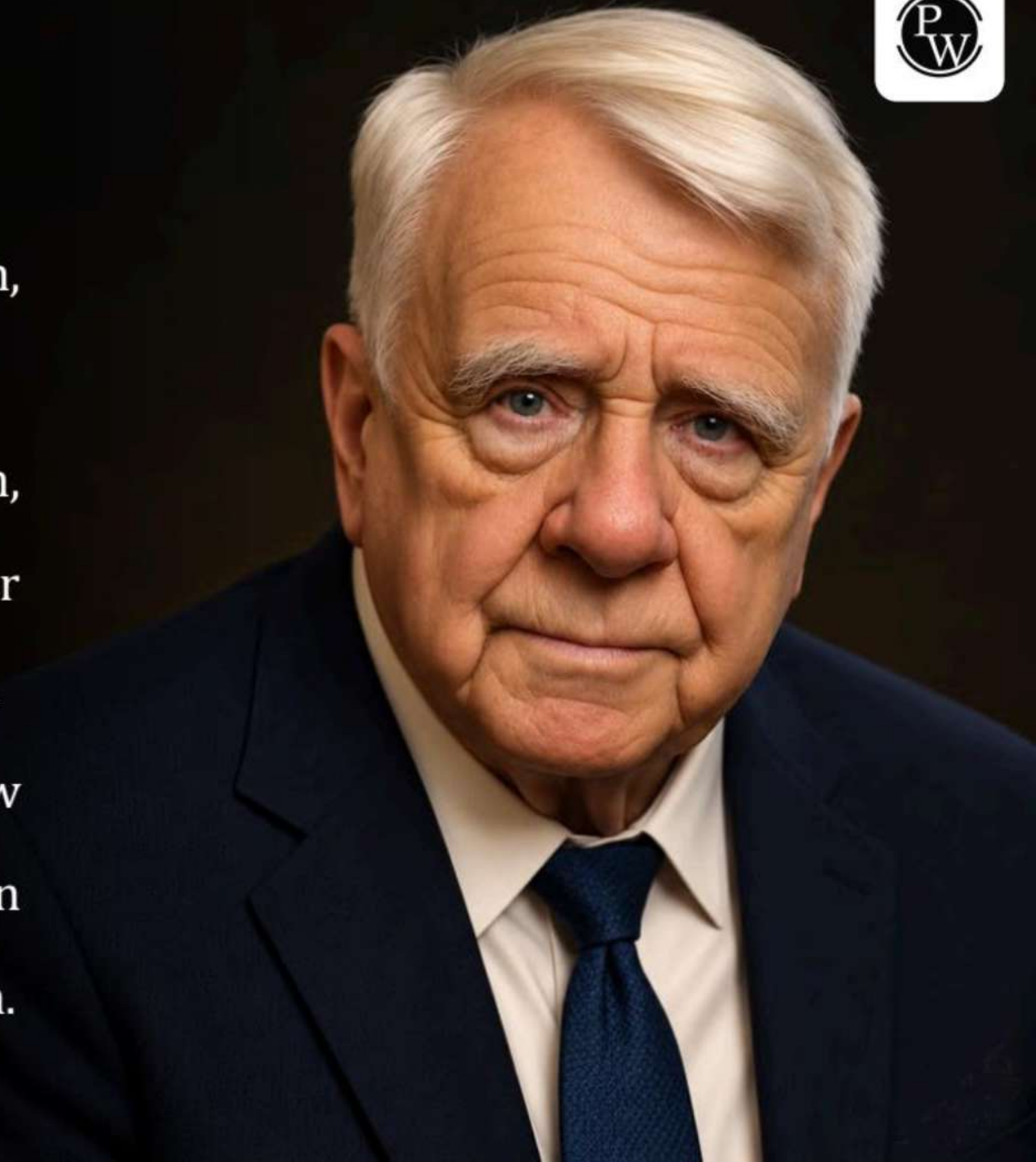
ANOTHER  
WORLD

STILL  
HERE  
STILL  
HOPING  
♥

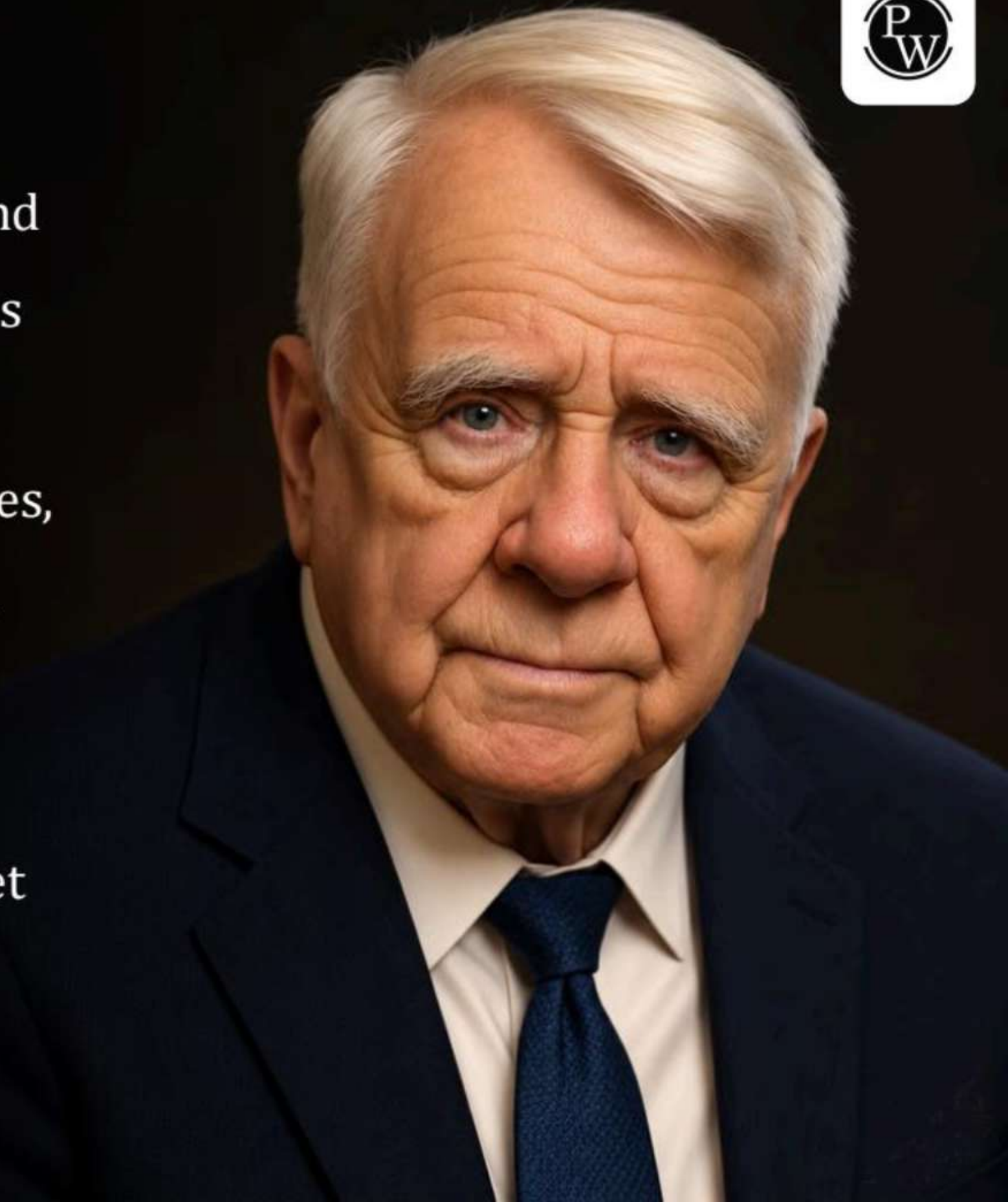
# About the Author



- Robert Frost (1874 - 1963), like Walt Whitman, was America's one of foremost poets.
- Aiming for both critical and popular acclaim, Frost hoped to achieve recognition as a major poet and to reach the widest possible audience.
- Although Robert Frost is considered a New England farmer-poet, he was born in San Francisco and lived there until the age of eleven.



- Robert Frost wrote about characters, people and landscapes.
- His poems are concerned with human tragedies and fears, his reaction to the complexities of life and his ultimate acceptance of his burdens.
- Stopping by the Woods on a Snowy Evening, Birches, Mending walls are a few of his well-known poems.
- Frost received many awards and prizes which included Bollinger Poetry Prize (1963) and four Pulitzer Prizes. He was also the only American poet honoured with an invitation to read his work at a presidential inauguration.



# Introduction



- "A Roadside Stand" highlights the stark reality of class difference between the city rich and the rural poor and calls for deepest sympathy and concern for the rural people.
- In this poem, Frost presents the lives of poor deprived people with great clarity, deepest sympathy and humanity.



# Stanza 1

(small shelter , छोटी झोपड़ी)

The little old house was out with a little new shed

(corner , किनारा)

In front at the edge of the road where the traffic

(moved fast , तेज़ चला)

sped,

(desperately , दयनीय ढंग से) (begged , विनती की)

A roadside stand that too pathetically pled,

(not be right , उचित न होना)

(charity bread, दान की रोटी)

It would not be fair to say for a dole of bread,

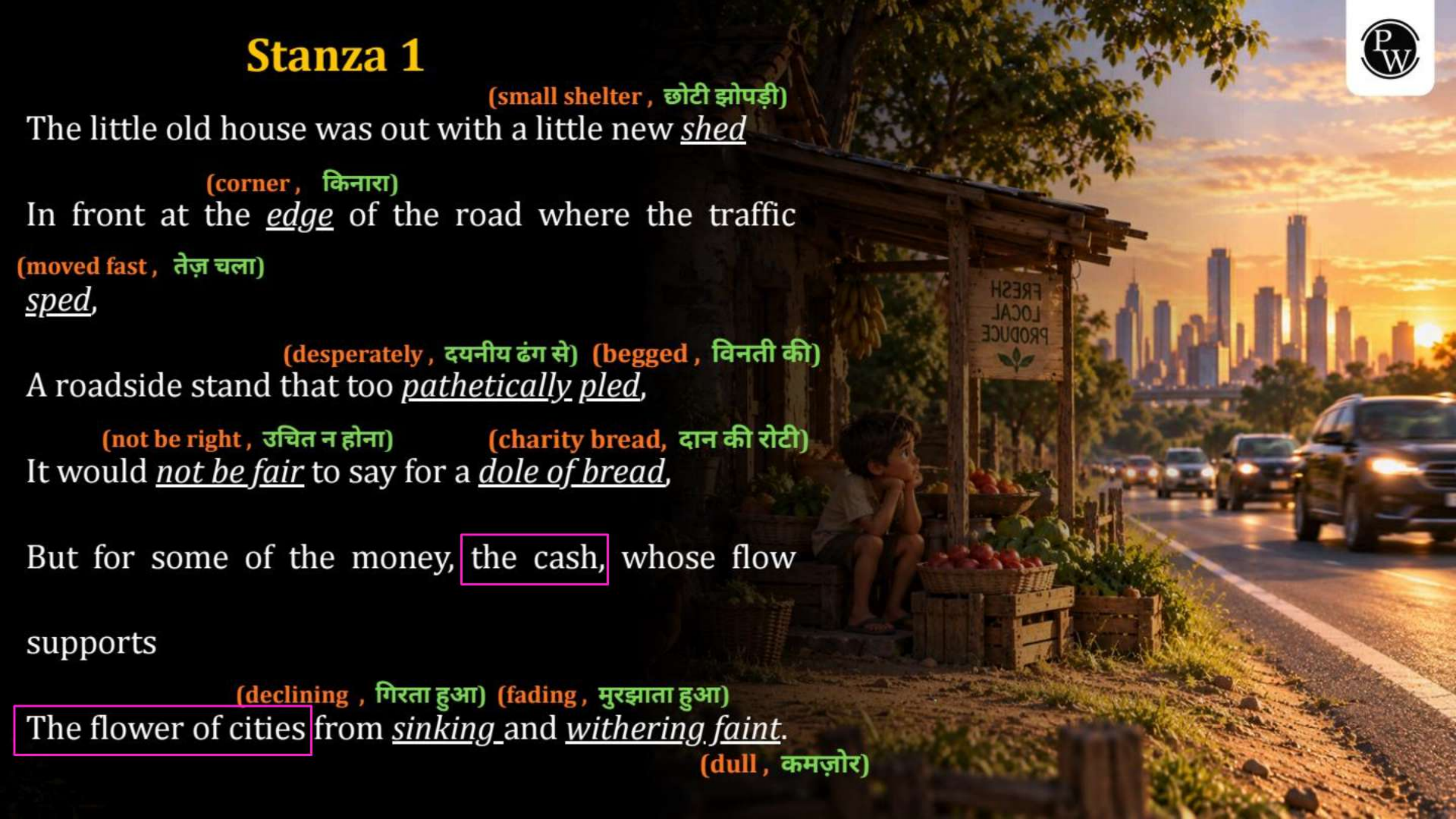
But for some of the money, the cash, whose flow

supports

(declining , गिरता हुआ) (fading , मुरझाता हुआ)

The flower of cities from sinking and withering faint.

(dull , कमज़ोर)



(shiny vehicles , चमकदार वाहन)

(attention ahead , आगे ध्यान)

The polished traffic passed with a mind ahead,

(upset , परेशान)

Or if ever aside a moment, then out of sorts

(scenery , दृश्य)

(spoiled , बिगाड़ा हुआ)

At having the landscape marred with the

(simple , साधारण)

artless paint

(went in the wrong direction , गलत दिशा में मुड़ गए)

Of signs that with N turned wrong and S turned

wrong.



(selling, बिक्री)

①

(containers, बर्तन)

Offered for sale wild berries in wooden quarts,

(curved-necked, टेढ़ी गर्दन वाला)

(yellow vegetable, पीली सब्जी)

Or crook-necked golden squash with silver

warts, spots

(skin bumps, मस्से)

②

(beautiful scenery, सुंदर दृश्य)

Or beauty rest in a beautiful mountain scene,

comfortable stay

You have the money, but if you want to be

(unkind, कठोर)

mean,

(angrily, गुस्से से)

Why keep your money (this crossly) and go

(away, चले जाना)

along.



## Stanza 2

(grievance, शिकायत)

The hurt to the scenery wouldn't be my complaint

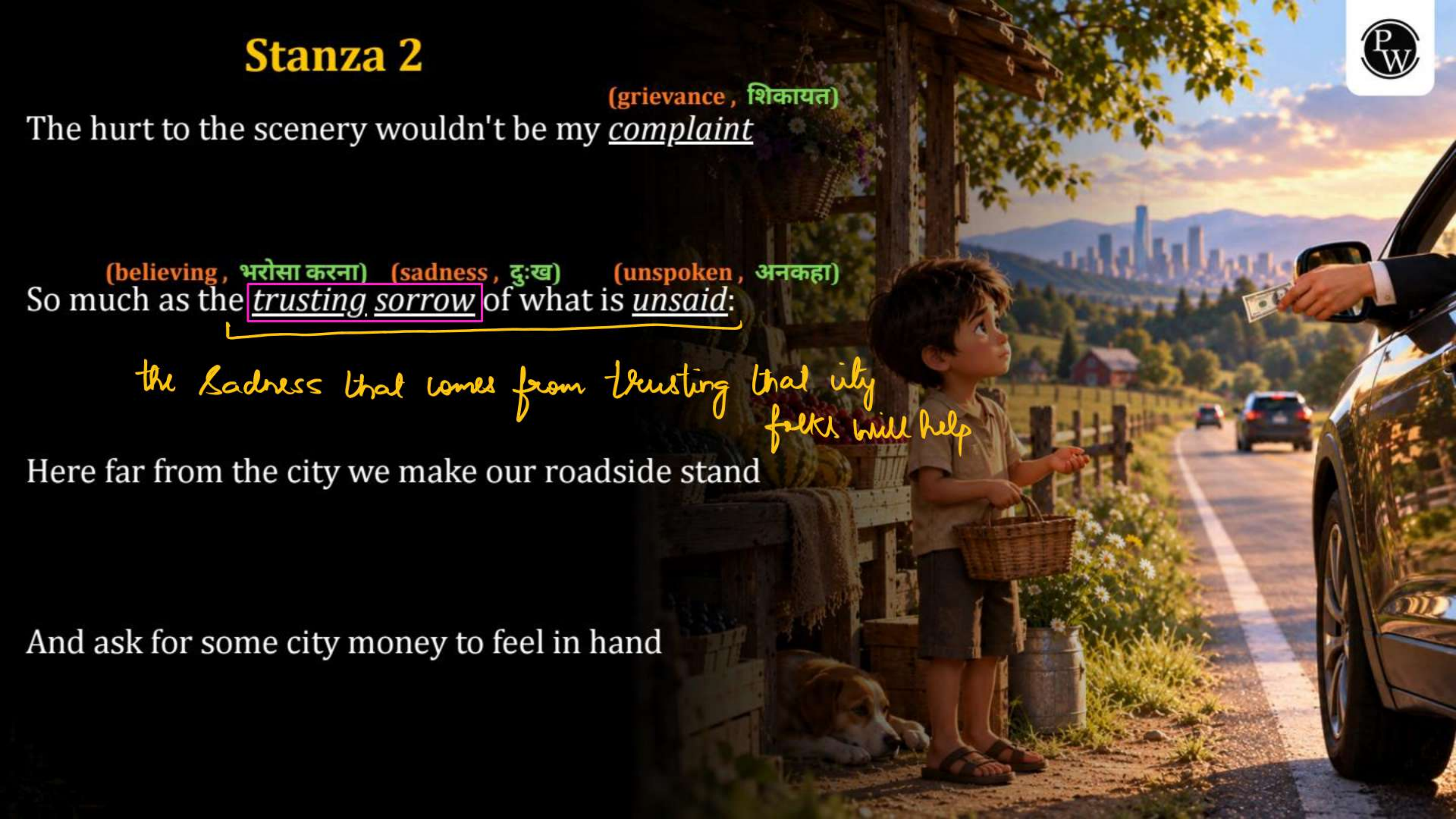
(believing, भरोसा करना) (sadness, दुःख) (unspoken, अनकहा)

So much as the trusting sorrow of what is unsaid:

*the sadness that comes from trusting that city  
folks will help*

Here far from the city we make our roadside stand

And ask for some city money to feel in hand



To try if it will not make our being expand,  
(growing, ~~शिक्षावत~~)  
existence ↳ grows

And give us the life of the moving-pictures'  
(films, फ़िल्में)  
promise

That the party in power is said to be  
(ruling party, सत्तारूढ़ दल)  
(hiding from us, हमसे छिपाना)  
keeping from us.

is not giving us



## Stanza 3

(helpless relatives, दयनीय रिश्तेदार)

It is in the news that all these pitiful kin

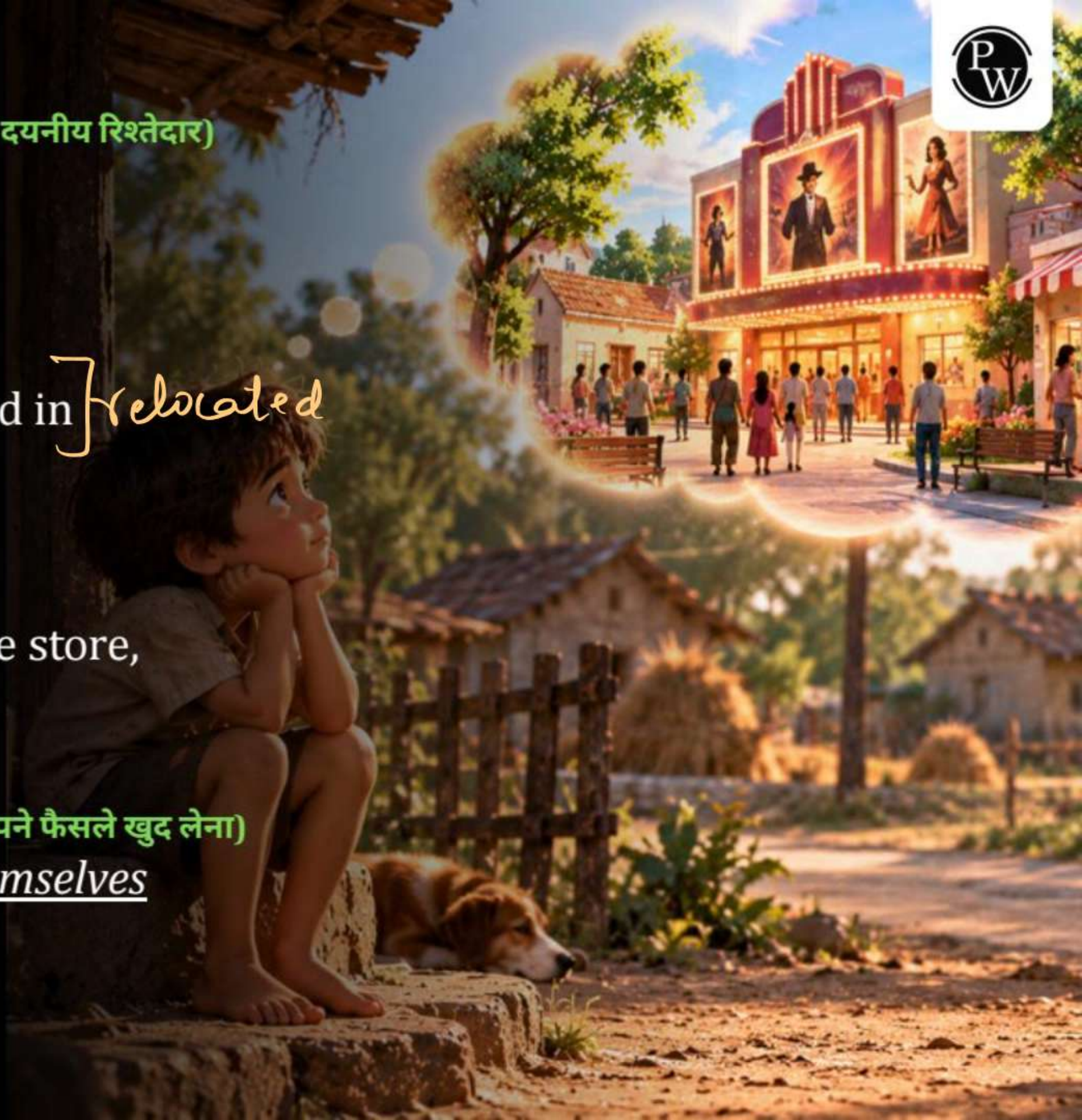
Are to be bought out and mercifully gathered in relocated

To live in villages, next to the theatre and the store,

(to decide for themselves, अपने फैसले खुद लेना)

Where they won't have to think for themselves

anymore.



(selfish helpers , स्वार्थी मददगार) (helpful predators , भले शिकारी)

While greedy good-doers, beneficent beasts of

(victim , शिकार)

prey,

(gather around , चारों ओर जुटना) (imposing , थोपना)

Swarm over their lives enforcing benefits

That are calculated to soothe them out of their

(intelligence , बुद्धि)

wits,

to fool them

And by teaching them how to sleep, they sleep

all day,

(very old, प्राचीन)

Destroy their sleeping at night the ancient way.



## Stanza 4

Sometimes I feel myself I can hardly bear  
( Tolerate , सहन करना )

The thought of so much childish longing in vain,  
( Strong desire , तीव्र इच्छा )  
( Without success , व्यर्थ )

( Stays hidden , छिपा रहता है )  
The sadness that lurks near the open window there,

That waits all day in almost open prayer



( High-pitched sound , चीख जैसी आवाज़ )  
For the squeal of brakes, the sound of a  
stopping car,

Of all the thousand selfish cars that pass,

Just one to inquire what a farmer's  
prices are.



( Turn over the soil , मिट्टी पलटना )

And one did stop, but only to plow up grass

(Land around a house , घर के आसपास की ज़मीन )

In using the yard to back and turn around;

And another to ask the way to where it

(Going towards a place , किसी स्थान की ओर जाने वाला )  
was bound;



And another to ask could they sell it a  
(Unit of petrol , पेट्रोल की एक इकाई )  
gallon of gas

They couldn't (this crossly); they had  
none, didn't it see?



## Stanza 5

(Wealth of the countryside , ग्रामीण धन )

No, in country money, the country scale of gain,

( Rural measure of prosperity ,

ग्रामीण समृद्धि का माप ) margin of profit

(Needed happiness , उत्साह )

The requisite lift of spirit has never been found,

(Feelings of rural people , ग्रामीण लोगों की आवाज़ )

Or so the voice of the country seems to complain,

(having , प्राप्त करना )

I can't help owning the great relief it would be



To put these people at one stroke out of their  
( a sudden action , झटका )  
pain.

( Mentally normal , मानसिक रूप से स्वस्थ )  
And then next day as I come back into the sane,

( ask myself , मैं सोचता हूँ )  
I wonder how I should like you to come to me

( Softly , धीरे से )  
And offer to put me gently out of my pain.





# MCQ's



Q. What does the roadside stand “pathetically plead” for?

- A) A dole of bread
- ✓ B) Financial support
- C) Attention from the government
- D) Improved infrastructure



Q. What metaphor is used to describe the city's reliance on financial support?

- A) A dying plant
- ✓ B) The flower of cities
- C) An aging building
- D) A broken machine

Q. What does the poet suggest about the city's treatment of the rural people? ☆☆

- A) It is supportive and understanding ✗
- B) It is indifferent and neglectful
- C) It is beneficial and generous ✗
- D) It is exploitative and predatory ✓

Q. What does the poet suggest is the purpose of the rural people asking for money?

- A) To buy luxury items
- B) To support their local business
- ✓ C) To feel a sense of worth and expand their existence
- D) To fund community events

# Summary



The speaker saw an old little house by the side of a road. Its shed had been recently renovated. Vehicles passed by this stand at a great speed. The inmates of the roadside stand stood expectantly, waiting for a passers-by to halt for food and refreshments. They craved for some city money to fall into their share so that they could support their lives with it. The money city folk spent in saving their flowers from fading away, could be better used in supporting the lives of village folk from sinking.

However, city folk were indifferent to the lot of the rural life. Their vehicles passed through the highway with their drivers' minds set on their destination. Those who cared to stop were quite critical of the poor decor of the stand and its artless interior and paint. They would also complain about the signs of 'N' and 'S' being turned wrong. The rich city dwellers passing by the stand would also disapprove of the wild berries and the crook-necked squash offered for sale here. They felt that these unhygienically maintained roadside stands marred the scenic beauty of the beautiful mountain scene in that area.

The speaker questions the rich city dwellers why they are being mean and stingy although they have a lot of money. He does not want to complain about the harm these people cause to the natural scenery. He is more concerned about the pain and sorrow reflected by the unsaid words of these simple people who trust that the city people would share their affluence with them. The poor rustic folks establish their roadside stand far away from the city and hope that some money from the rich city dwellers would pass into their hands and it will help them grow and enjoy a comfortable living.

By letting some city-money pass into their hands, the city dwellers will probably keep their promise of providing them economic independence, which the ruling party has failed to do.

The speaker further remarks that he had heard in the news that all the poor people like him would be drawn out of their poverty and be privileged to live a comfortable life in their villages. They will also be able to taste the urban comforts of having a theatre and a store. Hence, they will not have to worry about their living.

The capitalists and the men in power impersonate as the benefactors of these village folk but in their greed, these beasts of prey impose themselves on the country people and lure them with benefits which are tactfully calculated by them. They come with vain promises to provide the country dwellers benefits which would comfort them beyond their imagination. Thus tempted and lured, innocent rustics forget to know about and protect their rights. Their greedy benefactors then sleep over their promises leaving these poor people even more miserable and wretched.

The speaker feels that sometimes he cannot bear the thought of having to face so much deprivation. He craves in vain like a child for his wishes to be fulfilled. He is sensitive to the sadness he sees in the open windows of the roadside stand where the owners wait expectantly with prayer for the shrieking of the brakes or the sound of a car stopping. In that lies their hope of earning some city money. They hope vainly that of all the thousand cars that speed away past their stand, at least one would stop even if it is to enquire about the prices.

When one does stop, their hopes are shattered, for it only digs up the grass and uses the yard to back and turn around or to enquire for the way to its destination. Sometimes some motorists stop to enquire if they could buy a gallon of gas from the stand. This indifferent and unfeeling behaviour upsets the country folk tremendously.

The speaker finally laments that the spirit to economic progress is not found in the countryside. The country folk thus voice their complaints against such disparity.

The speaker accepts unequivocally (expresses his intention clearly and firmly) that it would be a great relief work if these poor rustics could be driven out of the pain of poverty.

He then wonders about the situation when he would gain his sanity, how he would desire his countrymen to pull him out of his pain.

The last lines of the poem probably express the poet's lament that he was not recognised so well in his own country America where he earned his due recognition only after having proved his mettle in Britain.

# Theme



The poem "A Roadside Stand" is a sympathetic and humane outcry against the economic disparity that prevails in the cities and the countryside. The poor, deprived rustics wait for city money to roll into their hands so that they can also enjoy a comfortable life. The city dwellers pass by the old sheds of these roadside stands in an insensitive manner, paying no heed to the expectant eyes of the poor rustics who look up to them for help. If ever anyone stops there it is only to lash out their complaints against the ugly and unhygienic surroundings.

# Theme



The poet thus brings out the wide disparity between the 'haves' and the 'have-nots'. He seems to suggest that the economic well-being of a country depends on a balanced development of both the villages and the cities.

- **Pathetically** : pitifully
- **Pled** : made an earnest request or appealed
- **Withering** : becoming dried up and dead
- **Out of sorts** : upset
- **Marred** : spoiled
- **Quarts** : bottles or containers
- **Kin** : a group of people of common ancestry
- **Mercifully** : compassionately
- **Beneficent** : generous

- **Swarm** : to throng
- **Enforcing** : imposing or compelling
- **Soothe** : calm
- **Longing** : a strong desire
- **In vain** : without successor result
- **Lurks** : lies hidden
- **Squeal** : a shrill sharp cry or noise
- **Plow up** : to break up the surface of the ground by driving across it again and again
- **Bound** : ready to travel in a particular direction or to a particular place.
- **Requisite** : necessary or required
- **A tone stroke** : with a single immediate action
- **Sane** : sensible and reasonable

# NCERT QUESTIONS



✓ Q. The city folk who drove through the countryside hardly paid any heed to the roadside stand or to the people who ran it. If ~~a tall~~ *at all* they did, it was to complain. Which lines bring this out? What was their complaint about?

✓ Q. What was the *appeal* plea of the folk who had put up the roadside stand?

✓ Q. The government and other social service agencies appear to help the poor rural people, but actually do them no good. Pick out the words and phrases that the poet uses to show their double standards. ✓

✓ Q. What is the 'childish longing' that the poet refers to? Why is it 'vain'? ★

✓ Q. Who does the poet accuse of having double standard in 'The Roadside Stand'?

(CBSE 2023)

✓ Q. What does the expression 'polished traffic' refer to? What does it reveal about city people?

(CBSE 2023)

✓ Q. Though money holds the same value everywhere, the poet draws a distinction between city money and country money. Elaborate.

(CBSE Question Bank 2021)

Q. Who does the poet accuse of having double standard in 'The Roadside Stand'?

(CBSE 2023)

Ans. The poet accuses the so-called benefactors- the government and other social service agencies of having double standards. He does so because these authoritative people deceive the poor rural people by giving them hope of doing something good and instead reap only personal benefits out of it. When time comes to meet the promise, they forget them or just fulfil self-motives.

Q. What does the expression 'polished traffic' refer to? What does it reveal about city people?

(CBSE 2023)

Ans. The expression "polished traffic" refers to the cars and other vehicles that pass by the new shed at the edge of the road. It reveals that city people are in a hurry and have little time to spare for the people living in the countryside. They are focused on their own lives and goals and do not help the poor country people who are in dire need of a little extra earning to better their life.

Q. Though money holds the same value everywhere, the poet draws a distinction between city money and country money. Elaborate.

(CBSE Question Bank 2021)

Ans. The expression "polished traffic" refers to the cars and other vehicles that pass by the new shed at the edge of the road. It reveals that city people are in a hurry and have little time to spare for the people living in the countryside. They are focused on their own lives and goals and do not help the poor country people who are in dire need of a little extra earning to better their life.

Q. The roadside stand and the moving cars are a contrast around which the entire poem is woven. Expound.

(CBSE Question Bank 2021)

Ans. It is true that the roadside stand and the moving cars are a contrast around which the entire poem is woven. Throughout the poem, we are made to understand the conditions, hopes and desires of the roadside stand. The owners of the roadside stand want money to earn their survival and hope for the city dwellers to help them.

But in contrast to their hope are the moving cars in which the city dwellers come and show their cruelty and miserliness. They do not stop at the shop but when they do, they express irritation or have some other selfish motive. They overlook the pitiable condition of the stand and move on.

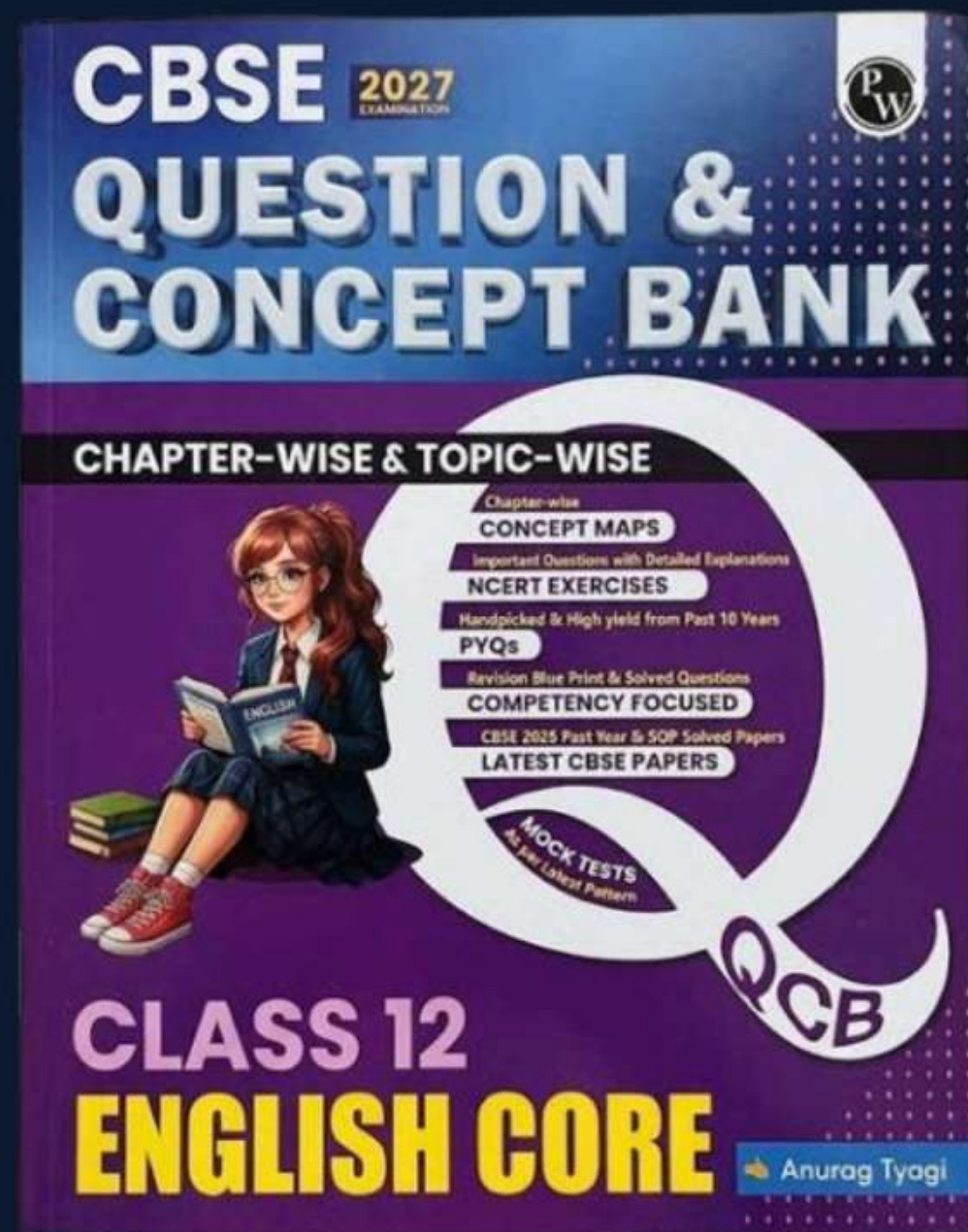
Q. What are the probable causes of the passing cars to stop near the roadside stand?

(CBSE 2020)

Ans. The probable causes of passing cars to stop near the roadside stand are as follows

- Cars stopped just to use the backyard of the place to reverse their car.
- Sometimes just to inquire about the directions for where they wanted to go.
- They also stopped to know if the roadside sellers could sell them a gallon of gas (petrol).

# English Sample Question Paper



AN



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# PWNSAT



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